

Artistic portfolio

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1 – bio-filmography



Foto: Francesca Carvallo

Julian Ospina Córdoba holds a degree in Multimedia Arts from Universidad Nacional de las Artes, Argentina. He was born in Bogotá, Colombia, on June 12, 1996. Before graduating from high school in 2014, he completed his first short film, *The Picture*, which won Best Screenplay at the Inter-School Film Festival (2014) and was showcased at the Bogotá Short Film Festival, Bogoshorts (2014). That same year, he directed *El Aguilucho*, a student magazine published continuously since 1927. Additionally, he created a series of audiovisual pieces for the theatrical production *Odiseo Irredento* by his father, Sebastián Ospina, with whom he toured the Colombian Caribbean as a live operator for the ensemble.

In 2015, he moved to Buenos Aires to begin film studies at the Universidad del Cine de Buenos Aires, where he produced the short film *Ida y vuelta* in 16mm format. This work was later exhibited at the FICCB (International Colombian Film Festival in Buenos Aires) and distributed on ShortsTV or TVCORTOS and digital platforms such as Amazon Prime. Outside the academic sphere, he has focused on editing and working with archival material. He describes his audiovisual practice as that of a "compiler and editor of his own, borrowed, and stolen audiovisual material."

The use of video calls is a recurring element in his work. These intimate and spontaneous recordings, captured through screens, have been a key source of creative material for his edits.

In 2020, he began his studies in Multimedia Arts at Universidad Nacional de las Artes in Argentina, and since then, he has directed his interest toward installation, synthetic imagery, artificial intelligence, deepfakes, and the way synthetic images undermine the evidentiary nature of photographs in contemporaneity. He has also explored sound experimentation with synthesizers, often performing under the pseudonym Hawk during live presentations. During the pandemic, he deepened his exploration of archival material and created the short film *Días felices* from his own documentary recordings, which premiered in the Documentary Panorama section of the Bogotá Short Film Festival, Bogoshorts (2021). He currently edits commissioned audiovisual pieces while developing his own installation and performance projects.

2 - extractions



Extracciones (2022)

Interactive Installation

V 1.0

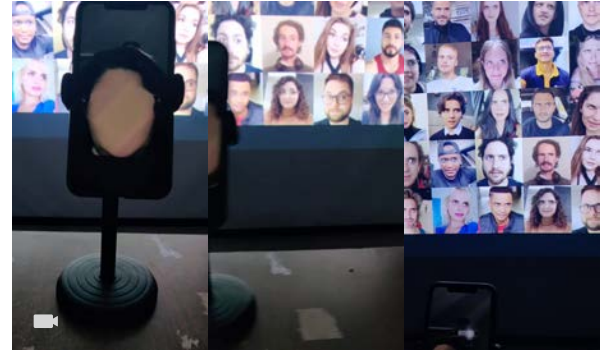
It is an installation space where users interact with a mobile phone that captures their biometric information and manipulates it using deepfake technique in a projection space where they are forced to do and say things against their will.

Upon entering the interactive space of the work *Extracciones*, we encounter a mobile phone that activates its front-facing camera. However, the image displayed on the screen erases our eyes, nose, and mouth in real time. The biometric information is nonetheless captured by the phone and subjected to advanced deepfake techniques, generating an altered projection in an adjacent space, creating the sensation that the face on the phone, rather than being erased, has been stolen

As spectators, we confront a distorted version of ourselves on a giant screen, witnessing how even our own image can be manipulated and used against us. In this regard, Dr. Jacob Bañuelos Capistrán (2020), in his publication *Deepfake: la imagen en los tiempos de la posverdad*, states, “Beyond whether digital documents represent reality, certify it, or legitimize it, a cultural challenge arises in which digital documents must be understood not only as representations of reality but as producers of it, regardless of whether they are true, false, legitimate, or authentic” (p. 53).

The work also raises questions about the control of our own biometric information, such as when we casually give it away, for instance, to have fun with filters on social media. As Christian Ferrer (2019) points out, “Everything—facial expressions, usage frequencies, online searches, even mouse movements—is absorbed and processed by emotion analysis systems. This represents a qualitative leap in the history of behavioral studies, with the aim of predicting thought or inducing it to alter decisions. This is what used to be called ‘mass suggestion’” (p. 178).

Extracciones explores notions of identity and individual freedom, prompting reflection on the scope of images in contemporary times and the limits of our autonomy in an increasingly connected and technologically advanced world.



Artistic References

Spectre (2019)

Bill Posters, who created the Spectre project (#Spectre) on Instagram (@bill_posters_uk) with an activist approach, produced a series of deepfakes featuring politicians and opinion leaders such as Donald Trump, Mark Zuckerberg, Jeremy Corbyn, Boris Johnson, and Kim Kardashian, in which they express contradictory or provocative statements. The project aims to warn about the risks of deepfakes as a tool for disinformation. The Spectre project has also taken the form of an interactive installation, proposing a more complex narrative and a different relationship with the device.

Tantat (2004)

This interactive work by Marcel Ll Antunez shares an important element with *Extracciones*: it uses facial capture of attendees to create the installation. However, in Antunez's case, it is not a deepfake, as it adopts an aesthetic closer to collage or caricature.

Días felices (2021)

Experimental Documentary | 21'50" |
Color | Spanish | 2021

Three friends (from Finland, Italy, and Colombia), who met while studying film in Argentina, gather via video call at the start of the pandemic to catch up and reminisce about old times. Julian, the young man from Colombia, is confronted by a strange voice that is aware of his successes and mistakes.





From an autobiographical perspective, *Días felices* proposes a fusion of images captured with an iPhone 5 during a birthday party in 2016 and a video call recorded at the start of the pandemic. In this video call, the author and two old friends nostalgically recall that past celebration while delving into deeper topics. The short film takes us to a stage of life where responsibilities are still limited, and effervescence and camaraderie flourish. However, the piece also reveals that those golden days were imbued with fragility, as distances and the adversity of *Hed* of the pandemic dramatically alter our perception of reality and our relationships with others.

The visual quality, far from perfect, creates an atmosphere of intimacy and nostalgia. The spontaneous nature of the materials is occasionally balanced by a second-person voice that, from a distance, establishes a dialogue with both the author/protagonist and the viewers.

The experimental nature of *Días felices* is revealed both in the unplanned origin of the recordings used and in the process of giving them meaning through editing. The production methods employed in creating the work align it more closely with contemporary artistic practices than with conventional filmmaking frameworks. The focus lies far more on the effects and processes than on the conception of a film as a finished product. This approach resonates with what José Luis Brea (2008) proposes in his *Redefinition of Artistic Practices* (p. 21): “There are no ‘works of art.’ There exists a work and practices that we can call artistic. They relate to the production of meaning, affect, and culture, and play specific roles in relation to subjects of experience” (p. 106).

Días felices explores themes such as distance, friendship, love, and impermanence. In a broader sense, the piece can be read as a poetic testimony that captures the beginning of an unstoppable shift toward a world dominated by interpersonal relationships mediated by data and screens.

Artistic References

Diaries, Notes, and Sketches (1990)

When discussing references for this type of approach to audiovisual work, it's hard not to mention Jonas Mekas, who tirelessly advocated for a cinema that was less perfect but freer. His often fragmentary and spontaneous recordings capture everyday moments and fleeting emotions. Works like *Diaries, Notes, and Sketches* have served as a reference for the use of intertitles and printed texts in *Días felices*.

4 – hawk



Hawk

(2020 - presente)

Sound art and performance

'Hawk,' a pseudonym derived from the phonetics of his initials JOC, is the name of a sonic experimentation venture that blends synthesizers, sampling, and drum machines. The project primarily unfolds through live performances, featuring occasional collaborations with other artists in the scene.

Without formal musical training, Hawk began experimenting with synthesizers, driven by a pure passion for sound. His performances range from ambient and immersive sessions to high-energy acts, often influenced by deep house and industrial techno. For these presentations, Hawk designs his own drum machines using Pure Data, a programming tool with which he generates random rhythmic sequences integrated via MIDI protocol into his live sets.

In his Drum Machine for Hawk, he explores the vital pulses of his body and electronic music through a device he created himself, using a heart rate sensor that triggers the kick drum with each heartbeat and micro-rhythmic sequences between beats: music to the rhythm of the body, and the body to the rhythm of the music. The piece highlights the vital experience and celebrates the notion of performance as understood by Erika Fischer-Lichte (2011), when she states, “The feedback loop bases itself on the alternating rhythmic tuning, also realized in the direct and reciprocal physical interaction of actors and spectators. This suggests that a rhythmic structure provides the autopoietic feedback loop with particularly favourable conditions for its fulfillment” (p. 153).

Hawk is interested in the feedback process and the energetic exchange that arises during live performances. In his sonic exploration, he has also developed a more intimate approach, through which he creates soundscapes that he has incorporated into his own audiovisual works.



Drum Machine para Hawk (2023)

Video documentation of the work. Version: 1.0



Artistic References

Hawk embraces his sonic journey, influenced by various sources, such as David August, who inspires his experimental approach to blending electronic and organic elements. In particular, Hawk has found inspiration in the way David August incorporates samples of dialogues from films and television series, adding an additional layer of expressiveness to his performances.



(24.09.22) Live en Multifest

*Created in spontaneous collaboration with Moreno, who was in charge of the visuals, adding another sensory layer to the feedback loop.

Teléfono roto (2025)

Interactive Installation

V I.O

Interactive installation that explores the failures of communication between humans and machines through obsolete technologies: a rotary phone and a CRT television. Instead of celebrating the efficiency of artificial intelligence, the piece emphasizes error, noise, and desynchronization. Synthetic voices and imprecise transcriptions generate a fragmented dialogue that weaves a collective poetic record in the style of an exquisite corpse.



In a context where language models promise smooth, almost human communication, this interactive piece responds with an awkward and fragmentary proposal. Teléfono roto connects a rotary phone and a CRT television through minimal digital processes, generating an interaction that highlights noise, error, and desynchronization. Through a local dictation system that captures words on the fly and a synthetic voice response mechanism, the piece activates forms of conversation or poetry that recycle previous interventions. Everything is built using modest tools that emphasize the limits of machine-mediated language.

When speaking into the phone, users see their words flow across the screen like an inverted teleprompter. The desynchronization between what is said and what is shown becomes a statement in itself. As John Durham Peters (2014) points out: “Electronic media have taught us the abysses in every conversation. Dialogues, after all, are composed of turns that may or may not successfully link with other turns. With a touch of wryness, a dialogue can simply be two people taking turns to direct emissions at each other. We tend not to recognize the voids at the deepest core of everyday exchanges, even though their negotiation is an achievement in which the best language users are experts (p. 256)”.

This work does not seek precision, but rather aims to raise questions about authenticity and connection in a world where immediacy prevails over accuracy. By integrating obsolete analog devices, it situates itself within media archaeology, as proposed by Jussi Parikka, recovering past technologies to question the present. In Teléfono roto, the intersection of analog and digital creates a sense of temporal suspension, where the user's words seem to flow and become trapped at the same time. The accumulation of voices and errors gives shape to a media-based exquisite corpse a living archive of distorted messages that reflects how, even in the digital present, we continue speaking through devices that listen, transform, and return our own voice back to us in distorted form.



Referentes artísticos

The Storyteller (1999)

Works like *The Storyteller* by Tom Jennings which combines teletypes, punched paper, and narratives about Alan Turing Teléfono roto likewise proposes a multiplicity of temporal layers through obsolete technological media.



Teléfono roto interaction log. Versión: 1.0
16 continuous minutes of user interaction

6 – References

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